

INSIDE THE INDUSTRY

**21% AND 29%.
SAME NAR.
DIFFERENT
BUYERS.**

One of these numbers has been costing you clients.

D.J. Paris
Keeping It Real Podcast

kale
Realty

learn more at joinkale.com

“

**THE 21 PERCENT
EVERYONE QUOTES
HAS BEEN COSTING
AGENTS REAL
BUYERS.**

NAR's other number says otherwise, and it's nearly a third of everything that closed last month.

21% IS A SURVEY. 29% IS WHO ACTUALLY CLOSED.

The 21 percent comes from NAR's November Profile of Home Buyers and Sellers, released 2025-11-04, a survey that asks buyers if this was ever their first home. NAR calls it a record low and has tracked the series since 1981. The 29 percent comes from NAR's July 2026 Existing-Home Sales report, released 2026-08-11, using mortgage data: anyone who hasn't owned a home in the past three years. That includes someone buying alone again after a divorce or the death of a spouse.

THREE THINGS TO DO WITH THE 8-POINT GAP:

- 1 Pull every past client who sold three or more years ago and never bought again.**
The mortgage definition already counts them as first-time buyers.
- 2 Watch for divorce and loss inside that list.**
NAR's data confirms buyers re-entering alone after a divorce or a death fall inside the 29 percent, not the 21.
- 3 Name the report when you cite the share.**
A sharp seller or buyer will ask which number you mean, and only one of them describes who's actually closing right now.

THE TAKEAWAY

**THE MORTGAGE
DEFINITION CALLS
THEM FIRST-TIME
BUYERS. YOUR
MARKETING CALLS
THEM NOTHING.**

Twenty-one and twenty-nine aren't a rounding error.
They're a call list already sitting in your database.